Acme Corporation - Employee Handbook
Version 3.2, effective 1 January 2026. Owner: People Operations.

1. About this handbook
This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Acme Corporation in India. Contractors and interns are covered by their own agreements unless a section says otherwise. If this handbook conflicts with your employment contract, your contract takes precedence.

2. Working hours
Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday to Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours, when everyone is expected to be reachable, are 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM. Flexible start times between 8:00 AM and 11:00 AM are allowed with your manager's agreement.

3. Leave

3.1 Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 20 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave accrues monthly at 1.67 days per month. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over to the next year; anything above 5 days lapses on 31 December. Annual leave requests of 3 or more consecutive days must be submitted at least 2 weeks in advance.

3.2 Casual leave

Employees receive 8 days of casual leave per year for short, unplanned absences. Casual leave cannot be carried over and cannot be combined with annual leave to extend a holiday. No more than 2 consecutive days of casual leave may be taken at once.

3.3 Sick leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for sick leave of 3 or more consecutive days. Unused sick leave does not carry over.

3.4 Parental leave

Birthing parents receive 26 weeks of paid maternity leave. Non-birthing parents receive 4 weeks of paid paternity leave, which must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption. Adoptive parents receive the same leave as birthing parents if the child is under 3 months old.

3.5 Public holidays

Acme observes 12 public holidays per year. The list is published by People Operations every December for the following year.

4. Remote and hybrid work
Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with their manager's approval. Remote days should be agreed at least one day in advance and recorded in the team calendar. Fully remote arrangements require approval from both the employee's manager and the Head of People Operations, and are reviewed every 6 months. Employees working remotely must use the company VPN and must not work from public Wi-Fi without it.

Acme provides a one-time home office allowance of 15,000 INR for employees approved for 2 or more remote days per week.

5. Probation and notice period
New employees serve a probation period of 3 months. During probation, either party may end employment with 2 weeks' notice. After probation, the notice period is 60 days for all employees, and 90 days for employees at Manager level and above. Notice may be shortened only with written approval from the Head of People Operations.

6. Performance reviews

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Salary revisions take effect from 1 April and are based on the April review. Promotions can be proposed in either cycle.

7. Benefits

All employees and their dependants (spouse and up to 2 children) are covered by group health insurance with a sum insured of 5,00,000 INR per year. Employees may add parents to the policy at their own cost. Acme contributes 12% of basic salary to the Provident Fund.

8. Raising concerns

Questions about this handbook go to People Operations at people@acme.example. Concerns about misconduct should be raised under the Code of Conduct, which describes the confidential reporting channel.